

Rheumocam 0.5 mg/ml oral suspension for cats

1. COMPOSITION

One ml contains:
Active substance
Meloxicam 0.5mg
Excipient
Sodium benzoate (preservative) 1.5mg

2. PRODUCT DESCRIPTION

A smooth light yellow suspension

3. PHARMACODYNAMICS

Meloxicam is a Non-Steroidal Anti-Inflammatory (NSAID) of the oxicam class which acts by inhibition of prostaglandin synthesis, thereby exerting anti-inflammatory, analgesic, anti-exudative and antipyretic effects. It reduces leukocyte infiltration into the inflamed tissue. To a minor extent it also inhibits collagen-induced thrombocyte aggregation. In vitro and in vivo studies demonstrated that meloxicam inhibits cyclooxygenase-2 (COX-2) to a greater extent than cyclooxygenase-1 (COX-1).

4. PHARMACOKINETICS

Absorption
If the animal is fasted when dosed, the maximal plasma concentrations are obtained after approximately 3 hours. If the animal is fed at the time of dosing, the absorption may be slightly delayed.

Distribution
There is a linear relationship between the dose administered and plasma concentration observed in the therapeutic dose range. Approximately 97% of meloxicam is bound to plasma protein.

Metabolism
Meloxicam is predominantly found in plasma and is also a major biliary excretion product whereas urine contains only traces of the parent compound. Five major metabolites were detected all having been shown to be pharmacologically inactive. Meloxicam is metabolised to an alcohol, an acid derivative and to several polar metabolites. As for other species investigated, the main pathway of meloxicam biotransformation in cat is oxidation.

Elimination
Meloxicam is eliminated with a half-life of 24 hours. The detection of metabolites from the parent compound in urine and faeces, but not in plasma is indicative for their rapid excretion. 21% of the recovered dose is eliminated in urine (2% as unchanged meloxicam, 19% as metabolites) and 79% in the faeces (49% as unchanged meloxicam, 30% as metabolites).

5. INDICATION

Alleviation of mild to moderate post-operative pain and inflammation following surgical procedures in cats, e.g. orthopaedic and soft tissue surgery.
Alleviation of pain and inflammation in acute and chronic musculo-skeletal disorders in cats.

6. ROUTE OF ADMINISTRATION

Oral use.

7. DOSAGE

Post-operative pain and inflammation following surgical procedures:
After initial treatment with Rheumocam 5 mg/ml solution for injection for cats, continue treatment 24 hours later with Rheumocam 0.5 mg/ml oral suspension for cats at a dosage of 0.05 mg meloxicam/kg body weight (0.1 ml /kg). The oral follow-up dose may be administered once daily (at 24-hour intervals) for up to 4 days.

Acute musculo-skeletal disorders:
Initial treatment is a single oral dose of 0.2 mg meloxicam/kg body weight (0.4 ml/kg) on the first day. Treatment is to be continued once daily by oral administration (at 24-hour intervals) at a dose of 0.05 mg meloxicam/kg body weight (0.1 ml /kg) for as long as acute pain and inflammation persist.

Chronic musculo-skeletal disorders:
Initial treatment is a single oral dose of 0.1 mg meloxicam/kg body weight (0.2 ml/kg) on the first day. Treatment is to be continued once daily by oral administration (at 24-hour intervals) at a maintenance dose of 0.05 mg meloxicam/kg body weight (0.1 ml /kg).
A clinical response is normally seen within 7 days. Treatment should be discontinued after 14 days at the latest if no clinical improvement is apparent.

Method of administration
A one ml syringe is provided with the product. The precision of the syringe is not suitable for the treatment of cats below 1 kg.
Shake well before use. To be administered orally either mixed with food or directly into the mouth.
Particular care should be taken with regard to the accuracy of dosing. The recommended dose should not be exceeded.
Avoid introduction of contamination during use.

8. CONTRAINDICATIONS

Do not use in pregnant or lactating animals.

Do not use in cats suffering from gastrointestinal disorders such as irritation and haemorrhage, impaired hepatic, cardiac or renal function and haemorrhagic disorders.

Do not use in case of hypersensitivity to the active substance or to any of the excipients.

Do not use in cats less than 6 weeks of age.

9. WARNINGS AND PRECAUTIONS

Special warnings for each target species:

None.

Special precautions for use in animals:

Avoid use in any dehydrated, hypovolaemic or hypotensive animal, as there is a potential risk of increased renal toxicity.

Post-operative pain and inflammation following surgical procedures:

In case additional pain relief is required, multimodal pain therapy should be considered.

Chronic musculoskeletal disorders:

Response to long-term therapy should be monitored at regular intervals by a veterinary surgeon.

Special precautions to be taken by the person administering the veterinary medicinal product to animals:

People with known hypersensitivity to non-steroidal anti-inflammatory drugs (NSAIDs) should avoid contact with the veterinary medicinal product.

In case of accidental ingestion, seek medical advice immediately and show this package leaflet or the label to the physician.

10. INTERACTIONS WITH OTHER MEDICAMENTS

Other NSAIDs, diuretics, anticoagulants, aminoglycoside antibiotics and substances with high protein binding may compete for binding and thus lead to toxic effects. Rheumocam

must not be administered in conjunction with other NSAIDs or glucocorticosteroids.

Concurrent administration of potential nephrotoxic veterinary medicinal products should be avoided.

Pre-treatment with anti-inflammatory substances may result in additional or increased adverse effects and accordingly a treatment-free period with such veterinary medicinal products should be observed for at least 24 hours before commencement of treatment. The treatment-free period, however, should take into account the pharmacological properties of the products used previously.

11. STATEMENT ON USAGE DURING PREGNANCY AND LACTATION

The safety of the veterinary medicinal product has not been established during pregnancy and lactation. See section "Contraindications."

12. ADVERSE EFFECTS

Typical adverse reactions of NSAIDs such as loss of appetite, vomiting, diarrhoea, faecal occult blood, lethargy and renal failure have occasionally been reported. Gastrointestinal ulceration and elevated liver enzymes were reported in very rare cases. These side effects are in most cases transient and disappear following termination of the treatment but in very rare cases may be serious or fatal. If adverse reactions occur, treatment should be discontinued and the advice of a veterinarian should be sought.

The frequency of adverse reactions is defined using the following convention:

- very common (more than 1 in 10 animals treated displaying adverse reactions)
- common (more than 1 but less than 10 animals in 100 animals treated)
- uncommon (more than 1 but less than 10 animals in 1000 animals treated)
- rare (more than 1 but less than 10 animals in 10 000 animals treated)
- very rare (less than 1 animal in 10 000 animals treated, including isolated reports)

13. OVERDOSE AND TREATMENT

Meloxicam has a narrow therapeutic safety margin in cats and clinical signs of overdose may be seen at relatively small overdose levels.

In case of overdose, adverse reactions, as listed in section "Adverse reactions", are expected to be more severe and more frequent. In case of overdose symptomatic treatment should be initiated.

14. SPECIAL PRECAUTIONS FOR THE DISPOSAL OF UNUSED PRODUCT OR WASTE MATERIAL, IF ANY

Any unused veterinary medicinal product or waste materials derived from such veterinary medicinal products should be disposed of in accordance with local requirements.

15. STORAGE CONDITIONS

Do not store above 25°C.

Shelf life after first opening of the container:

15ml bottle: 6 months

16. PACKING

15 ml bottle with a measuring syringe.

FOR VETERINARY USE ONLY

Manufactured by :

Chanelle Pharmaceuticals Manufacturing Limited,
Dublin Road, Loughrea, Co. Galway, Ireland.

Registration Holder and repacker :

Rhone Ma Malaysia Sdn Bhd (200001023279),
Lot 18A & 18B, Jalan 241, Seksyen 51A,
46100 Petaling Jaya, Selangor, Malaysia.

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